



DENTALXCHANGE • PHASE 1 FINAL DELIVERABLE

Product and R&D Operating Model

OUR PURPOSE

Validate, improve, and activate

PREPARED FOR DENTALXCHANGE

October 2026
Product and R&D

West Monroe
Operating Model



AGENDA

What we will cover



01	Executive summary	P. 5
02	Practices Map	P. 10
03	Activation Summary	P. 13
04	Recommendations and roadmap	P. 17
05	Recommended next phase	P. 37

Artifacts open at a stage and close with a decision

REF	WORKING ARTIFACT	REVIEWER	PDLC STAGE	NAMED DECISION	CONCORD GATE
01	Opportunity Brief	Senior leader	Identify	Is the problem worth defining?	Concept/Strategy · G0
02	Product Brief	Senior leader	Define	Approve direction and measures	Design/Viability · G1/G2
03	Feature Brief	Product / Eng / QA or Design	Define→Build	Ready to build?	Design/Viability → Build
04	Technical Plan	Engineering + reviewers	Build	Ready to execute?	Build · G4
05	Test / QA / UAT Plan	QA; Product accepts UAT	Define→Release	Test evidence supports readiness	Parallel · Beta / Pilot
06	Initial Release / GTM	Named decision-maker	Define→Optimize	Go, Revise, Hold or Stop	Parallel · G5 launch / G6 review
AI	AI assistance today	Human review required	Build / Release	Recon agents; QA uses Claude	Release Agent is paused
RULE	Working rules	Product + Engineering	All six stages	Approve, Revise, Hold or Stop	Link systems; own/date unknowns

DELIVERABLE

03

Recommendations and activation roadmap



PRODUCT AND R&D

01

Executive summary



One coordinated plan for product and engineering

WHAT WE SAW

A SaaS business maturing

- Clearer product direction and ownership are needed.
- Engineering has foundations and leading pockets to extend.
- Product and Engineering must move together.

HOW IT ROLLS OUT

Pilot, measure, extend

- Now: four-week strategy spike; Quality, Test and Release pilots.
- Next: one initiative with clearer product artifacts and measures; strategy in parallel.
- Future: integrate in January; use what worked across teams.

LEADERSHIP DECISIONS

Name owners and enable pilots

- Approve product/engineering owners and selected pilots.
- Agree AI guardrails and sanctioned PHI tools.
- Provide release and Jira data access for the baseline.

Evidence first: validate priorities through live work; decide the wider operating model from the results.

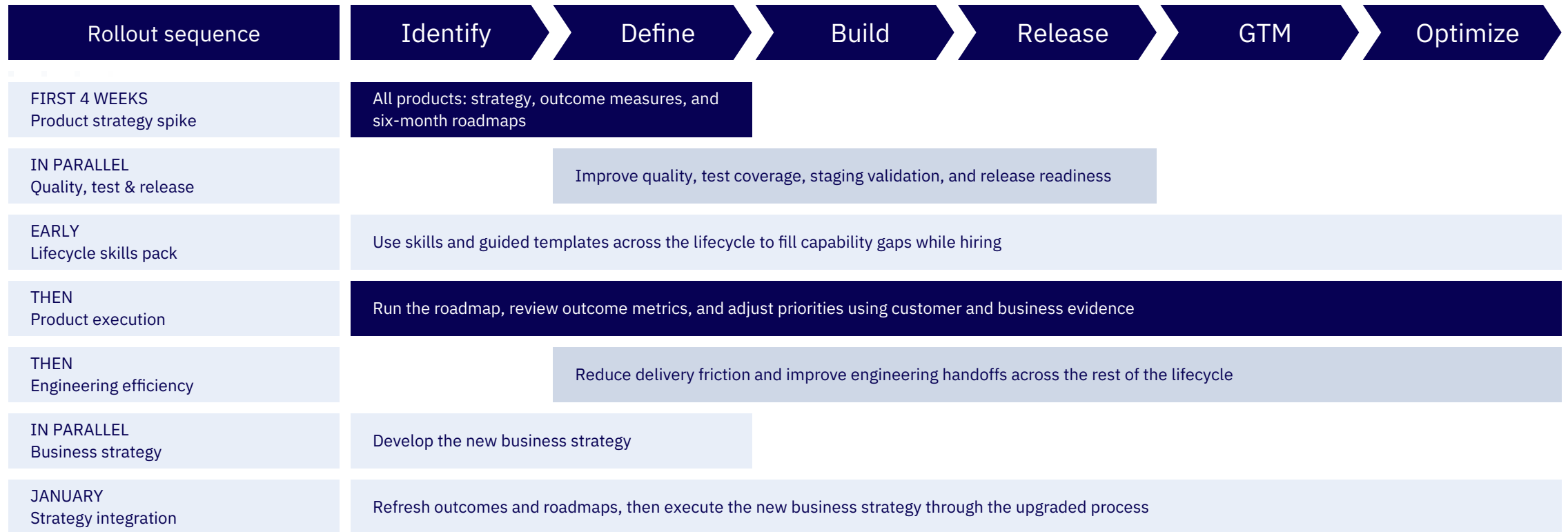
Source: Original Phase 1 findings and proposed horizons; detailed evidence and qualifiers retained in notes.

A dozen participants shaped the operating model

FUNCTION	PARTICIPANT	ORGANIZATION	DATE	FORMAT	LISTED	FOLLOW-UP	SOURCE
Engineering	Avinash Manjunath	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Engineering	Amal Endal	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Quality	Derrick Boyd	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
UAT	Allys Fritz	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
UAT	Mehdi Razavi	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Release	Ashok Kalyani	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Product	Archana Sabapathy	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Product	Troy Andrews	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Product	Sapna Sathyanarayana	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Engineering	Paul Smith	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Product	Navin Narayanan	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1
Engineering	Bob Franceschini	DXC	—	☐	☒	☐ Unstated	Phase 1

Source: Focused Engineering, Quality/UAT, Release and Product sessions plus a collaborative core-team workshop. Dates and follow-up details were not supplied.

Rollout sequence across the PDLC



Product · navy Engineering · gray Both / other · pale blue | Bars show phase coverage, not elapsed time. Outcome priorities now; new business strategy feeds the process in January.

PRODUCT AND R&D

02

Deliverables



Three deliverables, one working structure

01 Practices Map

Validated Product and R&D practices: observed strengths, gaps and opportunities.

02 Activation Summary

Bounded changes tested in live work, early signals and a repeatable activation playbook.

03 Recommendations & roadmap

Prioritized practices, roles, decision rights, owners, measures, dependencies and feedback loops.

Practices Map: working categories across the PDLC

PRACTICE AREA	IDENTIFY	DEFINE	BUILD	RELEASE	GTM	OPTIMIZE
Customer evidence	1	0	0	0	0	0
Roadmap and prioritization	2	0	0	0	0	0
Ownership and decisions	0	2	0	0	0	1
Product definition and design	0	2	2	0	0	1
Product + Engineering	0	0	3	0	0	0
Release validation	0	0	0	1	0	0
Commercial enablement	0	0	0	2	2	1
Measurement and feedback	0	0	0	0	2	0
AI-enabled delivery	1	2	4	2	0	0

0 · Not rated 1 · Emerging 2 · Developing 3 · Variable/pocket 4 · Leading pocket

Source: Limited DXC conversations and observations. Display codes identify source categories; they are not measured scores or an average.

Engineering practices: working ratings by platform

ID	ENGINEERING PRACTICE	CORE (JAVA)	RECONCILE AI	EVIDENCE TO VALIDATE	OTHER PODS / ACTION
01	Technical design	Emerging	Leading pocket	Core owner gap; Recon TL signs	To validate
02	AI-assisted build	Developing	Leading pocket	Core Copilot Jan 2026; epic AI	Variable
03	Test automation	Emerging	Leading pocket	Core manual; XConnect ~100%	Variable
04	Release promotion	Developing	Developing	Rebuild hypothesis; CAB gaps	To validate
05	Access / test data	Emerging	Emerging	Months waiting; read-only gap	Emerging
06	Operability / run	Developing	To validate	2026: half unplanned; credentials	To validate
07	Delivery measures	Emerging	Emerging	Core ~65 pts; no DORA baseline	Emerging
08	Knowledge sharing	Emerging	Emerging	Senior dependency; onboarding gaps	Emerging

Three deliverables, one working structure

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From signal to implementation plan

Test the decision path on one live initiative before committing delivery scope. Engineering signs the design.

FRAME THE OPPORTUNITY

01 Signal

Customer, support, operations, research or engineering evidence.

02 Opportunity

Problem, evidence, outcome, decision and why now.

03 Product / PRD

User need, success measure, scope and design context.

PREPARE DELIVERY

04 Feature / epic

Decomposition, acceptance, ownership and dependencies.

05 Technical design

Architecture, PHI, security, effort and risk. Eng. signs.

06 Delivery plan

Sequence, validation, release evidence and feedback.

Three tests turn recommendations into evidence

01 • SIGNAL FUNNEL

Test the opportunity

Run one internal signal through an opportunity brief with an outcome and decision criterion. Watch signal quality, decision speed and next-step clarity.

Weekly Product, Engineering and initiative-owner review.

02 • DEFINITION PATH

Test the handoffs

Carry a brief through PRD, feature/epic, technical design and plan. Watch handoff quality, rework, design context and decision clarity.

Joint Product and Engineering review before commitment.

03 • SHIP WITH PROOF

Test release evidence

Define the smallest evidence path before a release or client-facing test. Watch validation coverage, earlier issue discovery and owner clarity.

Before-release review, then post-launch learning. Record results, open questions and continued-use recommendations.

Two initiatives test different operating-model questions

RECONCILE AI

Build and release evidence

November 2026 MVP target. PRD, Figma, Architecture Spec, technical stories, UAT and Jira exist. Node/Angular/NX on AWS; lead, ~4 developers and 1 DevSecOps/QA. Epic agent pipeline; two-week promotion. Review scale: 100–145-file epic PRs; DevSecOps WIP limit 2. Test ship-with-proof and governed agents.

RULES ENGINE

Commit with engineering input

Discovery done; commercialization next. PRD + governance deck; no epic. Rough year-end MVP. Platform/team and Core capacity remain undecided.

Aspen / TeamTAG partner-client lane. Resolve Scrum/points versus epic Kanban. Test the signal funnel, definition path and priorities.

COMMON COMPARISON LENS

Six dimensions for both

Stage today; artifacts; platform and team; delivery approach; open questions; activation tests. The same six dimensions apply to each initiative.

Recon tests release evidence and agentic scale. Rules tests an engineering-informed commitment before setting a date.

Three deliverables, one working structure

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Activation Roadmap: product track

PRACTICE / FIRST PILOT	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
Outcomes • Rules	- Year-end decision criteria - Engineering effort + risk	- Protected support capacity - Credible 3–4 sprint view	- Outcome + capacity evidence - Across all pods
PM owner • Recon	- Map decision rights - Name outcome + learning owner	- After November MVP - Review adoption + results	- Own outcomes across pods - Learning beyond backlog
Definition • Rules	- Opportunity + Product Brief - Feature → Technical Plan	- Use on next initiative - Review named decisions	Concord-aligned definition path
Collaborate • Rules	- Book pre-commitment review - Minimum cross-functional team	- UX, QA, Release + Ops - Record open questions	Track wait + rework before commit
Proof • Recon	- Highest-risk client workflow - Before November MVP	- Smallest release evidence path - Compare before + after issues	Results + adoption guide roadmap

PRD → signed tech spec → release evidence

01 • PRD

Confirm the problem

Start with the existing PRD; no epic exists yet. Product confirms scope and the success measure. Rules Engine platform is undecided.

Watch-out: sanctioned tools and PHI rules must be in place.

02 • TECH SPEC

Keep a human gate

The Architecture Design Agent drafts technical design and stories. The Team Lead reviews and signs. Test reuse outside Reconcile AI.

Measure PRD-to-signed-spec time and review rework.

03 • RELEASE

Define the evidence

Product specifies release notes, PRD reconciliation and destinations. This unblocks the Release Agent. Test ways of working, not production changes.

Learn what Product needs from release evidence.

Activation Roadmap: engineering track

PRACTICE / FIRST PILOT	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
E1 Stability · Core	- Review 15 unplanned changes - Credential / certificate owners	- Patch + rollback reviews - Alerts; same artifact; CAB	- Track failures + restore time - Investigate repeat causes
E2 Tests · Core	- Highest-risk regression map - Manual effort per release	- Automate high-risk workflows - Reuse in Eligibility + Pay	- Regression is release entry - Across every pod
E3 Access · Recon/Rules	- Log access / data waits - Record reasons + duration	- Masked Recon test data - Read-only, including offshore	Self-service environments
E4 Measures · Core/Recon	- Release frequency + lead time - Change failure + restore time	- Recon flow metrics live - Monthly view includes vendor	Evidence informs priorities
E5 AI · Recon	- Automate / assist / review - Sanctioned PHI tools	- Registry + Eligibility AI - Core pilot before December	Scale speed + quality gains

CORE • PRODUCTION CALENDAR

**2026: ≥3 defects;
2 rollbacks.**

Only Recon owns technical design before build. End-to-end and vendor delivery measures are missing.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Engineering + Product own the pilot.

ENGINEERING • QUALITY

Sign design before build

Now
FIRST PILOT

Rules: PRD → reviewed, signed agent tech spec

Baseline frequency, lead time, failure and restore

People sign before build begins

Next
EXTEND

Core technical design template; Recon flow metrics

Monthly quality view includes the vendor team

Compare escaped defects and lead time

Future
SCALE

Quality evidence informs portfolio decisions

Use change failure, defects and lead time together

Scale the practices that improve results

Planning horizons are not committed delivery dates; validate the pilots before extending.

STATUS TODAY

Core regression is manual; QA capacity is limited.

Recon writes Jest, Playwright and Postman tests. XConnect is ~100% automated; other pods are partial.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Quality + DevOps + Security own the pilot.

ENGINEERING • TEST

Automate high-risk tests

Now FIRST PILOT

Map Core high-risk regression and manual effort

[Use release causes; log access/data waits](#)

Record who waits, why, and how long

Next EXTEND

Automate high-risk Core workflows; reuse Recon AI

[Extend to Eligibility AI and Pay Connect](#)

Masked data + approved read-only diagnostics

Future SCALE

Regression evidence becomes a release entry gate

[Self-service environments and access](#)

Measure coverage, escaped defects and wait time

Planning horizons are not committed delivery dates; validate the pilots before extending.

To Sep 1: 62 releases; 15 patches.

Calendar: half of 2026 unplanned.
Rebuild hypothesis: confirm.
CAB gaps; credential patches.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Engineering + Release/DevOps own
the pilot.

Make releases reliable

Now FIRST PILOT

Review 15 unplanned 2026 changes and root causes

[Inventory credential owners and expiry dates](#)

Product defines Release Agent evidence

Next EXTEND

Promote the validated artifact; alerts and reviews

[Bring products into CAB; clarify config switches](#)

Run the Recon Release Agent in staging

Future SCALE

Low-risk, on-demand releases use automated gates

[Reuse the Release Agent pattern across pods](#)

Measure unplanned changes, rollbacks and causes

Planning horizons are not committed delivery dates; validate the pilots before extending.

Scale the strengths; resolve the constraints

OBSERVED STRENGTHS

Pockets worth scaling

- Portfolio governance and commercial gates are emerging
- Reconcile AI is a leading agentic delivery pocket
- Skills, MSPs and a Git-based source of truth are documented

OBSERVED GAPS

Constraints to resolve

- Customer commitments and late scope changes reduce predictability
- Product ownership often centers on intake, backlog and sprint scope
- Engineering, UX, QA, Release and Operations join after commitments

MAPPED OPPORTUNITIES

Future-state themes

- Outcome-led priorities and protected capacity
- Product management as business ownership
- Earlier collaboration and governed, reusable lifecycle AI

Start with a bounded live test, then measure and extend the practices that work.

Source: Working observations from the Phase 1 conversations; validate the findings with DentalXChange.

Five recommendations to activate the product track

01 Outcome-led priorities

ACTIONS

- Set decision criteria
- Protect capacity; 3–4 sprint view

TIMING

Immediate

02 PM business ownership

ACTIONS

- Own evidence and outcomes
- Roadmap, adoption and learning

TIMING

Immediate

03 Definition path

ACTIONS

- Signal → PRD → feature / epic
- Design → implementation plan

TIMING

Immediate

04 Earlier collaboration

ACTIONS

- Include UX, Eng, QA, Release, Ops
- Living evidence before commitment

TIMING

Near-term

05 Governed agentic delivery

ACTIONS

- Reusable, human-supervised AI
- Discovery through learning

TIMING

Future

READING GUIDE • WHAT EACH RECOMMENDATION CHANGES

Commitments need effort + risk

PM goes beyond the backlog

Carry the decision through

Reduce late discovery

Measure speed + quality

Outcome-led prioritization

Product + Engineering · use commitment, scope and unplanned-work evidence.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Decision criteria

Value, urgency, feasibility and dependencies.

02 Protected capacity

Reserve support capacity; show 3–4 credible sprints.

03 Informed commitments

Engineering effort and risk precede customer dates.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Live initiative

Apply the criteria to the next priority decision.

05 Record trade-offs

Compare scope with evidence and available capacity.

06 Review predictability

Track scope changes, rework and flow data.

Product as business ownership

Product leadership · evidence-backed decisions and post-launch learning.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Own outcomes

Customer evidence through post-launch learning.

02 Decision rights

Clarify PM, PO, Engineering, Sales and Ops roles.

03 Business context

Carry decision logic in the opportunity brief and PRD.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Find one gap

Map rights that slow the live initiative.

05 Name the PM owner

Assign ownership for outcomes and the learning loop.

06 Review results

Adoption and business results alongside delivery.

RECOMMENDATION 03

Make the definition path repeatable

Product + Engineering · measure handoff quality, rework and decision clarity.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Opportunity content

Problem, evidence, outcome, decision and why now.

02 Carry the logic

PRD → feature / epic → design → delivery plan.

03 Before commitment

Name owners, acceptance, dependencies and evidence.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Start from a signal

Complete one live opportunity brief.

05 Review before PRD

Product, Eng, UX and sponsor review the brief.

06 Trace handoffs

Record gaps and rework through the delivery plan.

Collaborate before commitment

Product + Engineering · measure rework, wait time and earlier issue discovery.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Minimum team

Name the team and artifacts before commitment.

02 Early feasibility

Include Product, UX, Eng, QA, Release and Ops.

03 Living documentation

One source of truth supports handoffs and reuse.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Working session

Test pre-commitment review on one initiative.

05 Shared questions

Record design, release and operational unknowns.

06 Compare evidence

Track wait time, rework and late discovery.

Ship with proof and learn

Product + Release + Operations · validation, defects and time to feedback.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Small evidence path

Workflow, data, owner and a decision threshold.

02 Realistic validation

Partner / client conditions, not synthetic comfort.

03 Close the loop

Post-launch results inform roadmap priorities.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 First test: Recon

Name the highest-risk client workflow.

05 Before release

Product, Eng, Release, Ops and owner review evidence.

06 Improve the checklist

Compare issues before and after release.

Govern AI throughout the lifecycle

Engineering + Product · measure cycle time, defects, rework, cost and reuse.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Classify the work

Automate, assist or review; sanction PHI tools.

02 Reusable skills

Shared prompts, context, documentation and versions.

03 Speed and quality

Track cycle time, defects, cost and review evidence.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Now: Recon

Classify pipeline steps; approve PHI-bearing tools.

05 Next: Eligibility

Registry and gated Core pilot before December.

06 Future: scale

Extend only what improves speed and quality.

Activation Roadmap

RECOMMENDATION	OWNER	FIRST ACTION	TIMING / DEPENDENCY	MEASURE
Prioritize outcomes	Product + Eng	Apply criteria to the next live priority decision.	Immediate · Decision criteria	Predictability
PM business ownership	Product	Name PM outcome owner; map decision rights.	Immediate · Role clarity	Outcome learning
Definition path	Product + Eng	Signal → PRD → epic → design → plan	Immediate · Shared artifacts	Handoff quality
Earlier collaboration	Product + Eng	Review feasibility before commitment	Near-term · Cadence and access	Rework and wait time
Ship with proof	Product + Release	Define release proof and learning	Near-term · Measures	Validation coverage
Governed agentic delivery	Eng + Product	Test human-supervised AI outside the current pocket.	Future · Guardrails and skills	Cycle time, defects, cost

IMPLEMENTATION TEMPLATES

Briefs, plans and working decisions



Six artifacts turn definition into decisions

ARTIFACT	PDLC STAGE	OWNER	NAMED DECISION	FIRST PILOT
Opportunity	Identify	PM	Senior leader: worth defining?	Rules / PGB
Product / PRD	Define	PM	Approve direction and measures	Rules PRD
Feature brief	Define → Build	PM + Eng lead	Product/Eng/QA: ready to build?	Rules epic
Technical plan	Build	Eng lead	Reviewers: ready to execute?	Rules AI spec
QA / UAT plan	Define → Release	QA / Eng; Product UAT	Release readiness evidence	Recon MVP
Release / GTM	Define → Optimize	PM + functional leads	Named decider: Go / Revise / Hold / Stop	Recon release

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Artifact ownership matrix

L · Lead C · Contribute A · Approve

ROLE / STAKEHOLDER	OPPORTUNITY	PRODUCT	FEATURE	TECHNICAL PLAN	QA / UAT	RELEASE / GTM
Product Manager / Product Lead	L	L	C	C	C	L
Business / Initiative Sponsor	A	A	C	C	C	A
Product Owner / Delivery Lead	C	C	L	C	C	C
UX / Design	C	C	C	C	C	C
Engineering Lead / Architect	C	C	C	L	C	C
QA / UAT	C	C	C	C	L	C
Release / Operations	C	C	C	C	C	A
Sales / Customer Success	C	C	C	C	C	C
Leadership	C	C	C	C	C	C

Lead coordinates the artifact; contributors shape it; approvers decide readiness. Use these templates as decision points in the work, not documents completed after the fact.

PRODUCT AND R&D

03

Recommended next phase



PRODUCT STRATEGY

Product strategy spike

1 • OUTCOME

Clear product strategy and an executable six-month roadmap

2 • KEY ACTIVITIES • FOUR-WEEK SPIKE

01 • EVIDENCE

Evidence

- Review customer needs
- Review product performance
- Review business priorities

02 • STRATEGY

Strategy

- Prepare a strategy workshop
- Facilitate with product leaders
- Align on product strategy

03 • PRIORITIES

Priorities

- Set product-area direction
- Define measurable outcomes
- Agree roadmap trade-offs

04 • ROADMAP

Roadmap

- Complete product briefs
- Define ownership
- Complete six-month roadmap

3 • DURATION

4 wk strategy spike

DELIVERABLES

Product direction, measures and an executable six-month roadmap

PRODUCT TEAM

Sameer Karim · Executive PT
Mzati Kapalamula · Senior FT

TEAM ALLOCATION

Sameer: part time; Mzati: full time.

Source: DentalXChange working deck · proposed next phase

Scale Reconcile AI across Core

1 • OUTCOME

Reusable practices tested on a Core rules-engine pilot

2 • KEY ACTIVITIES • SIX WEEKS

PHASE	WHAT WE DO	WHAT YOU GET
Assess / refine Weeks 1–3	- Refine Recon’s AI library - Refine Core spec workflows - Map Core SDLC enhancements	Refined library and SDLC process map
Workshop Week 4	- Apply AI to real Core epics - Run a 3-day hands-on workshop - Work with selected DXC engineers	Hands-on training for Core team
Coach adoption Weeks 5–6	- Test reuse with Core teams - Coach adoption and plan rollout - Review pilot specs and access	Reuse plan and engineering coaching

Source: DentalXChange working deck · proposed next phase

3 • DURATION

6 wk

Proposed next phase
Core rules-engine pilot

DELIVERABLES

Skill library; SDLC map; delivery / product metrics; 3-day workshop; coaching.

TEAM

Eng leader PT: confirm
Gerardo Arroyo · Sr architect FT

Review specifications and access before any build extension.

Strengthen Core testing / release

1 • OUTCOME

More reliable release gates and critical-path test coverage

2 • KEY ACTIVITIES • SIX WEEKS

PHASE	WHAT WE DO	WHAT YOU GET
Prioritize Weeks 1–2	- Confirm journeys with Product - Confirm critical coverage gaps - Confirm release gates	Testing assessment / focus areas
Automate Weeks 3–4	- Expand Playwright coverage - Reuse AI test workflows - Add a sprint of E2E capacity	AI testing skills / E2E coverage
Validate / coach Weeks 5–6	- Test priority paths in staging - Exercise release checks - Assign owners; scope backlog	Environment / release recommendations

Source: DentalXChange working deck • proposed next phase

3 • DURATION

6 wk

Proposed next phase
Critical paths and release gates

DELIVERABLES

Testing focus; environment / release controls; E2E capacity; AI skills; Evolve evidence / journey inventory.

TEAM

Executive Eng leader: PT
QE architect + Sr engineer: FT

Transfer owners; scope pipeline / environment work.

Three parallel workstreams, one \$345K investment

1 • OUTCOME

Activate strategy and delivery

A four-week product strategy spike runs alongside two six-week engineering workstreams. Pricing covers all three together; no individual workstream fees are allocated.

WHAT YOU KEEP

- Product direction and six-month roadmap
- Reusable AI engineering practices on Core
- Critical-path tests and release controls

2 • TEAMS

Parallel workstreams • distinct durations

01 • FOUR WEEKS

Product strategy

- Sameer Karim • Executive PT
- Mzati Kapalamula • Senior FT
- Four-week strategy spike

02 • SIX WEEKS

AI engineering on Core

- Ri Scott • Executive PT
- Gerardo Arroyo • Architect FT
- Six-week Core enablement

03 • SIX WEEKS

Testing and release

- Ri Scott • Executive PT
- QE architect • full time
- QE senior engineer • full time

3 • COST

\$345K

total investment

\$370,000 total fees less \$25,000 Phase 1 credit

Pricing applies to all three workstreams

COMBINED INVESTMENT

Three parallel workstreams; distinct teams and four/six/six-week durations.

Source: Proposed Phase 2 package • original fees and team commitments retained.

Engineering findings and the leadership asks

PRODUCT TRACK

Input still pending

- What we saw: product team to complete
- Recommendations and rollout: product team to complete
- Leadership asks: product team to complete

ENGINEERING TRACK

Start with five pilots

- Recon leads design / AI / tests; Core regression is manual
- Half of 2026 Core changes unplanned; no end-to-end measure
- Pilot stability, regression, access, measures and sanctioned AI

LEADERSHIP

Name owners and enable access

- Agree E1–E5 owners and Core / Recon / Rules pilots
- Approve PHI rule and tools before December AIDLC
- Release / Jira data; extend to Eligibility and Pay; gated Core AI

Now: readout and first 30 days. Next: 1–3 months. Future: 3–6+ months.

Source: Working draft retained hidden. Product placeholders are source content, not completed findings.

Practices Map: earlier working categories

PRACTICE AREA	IDENTIFY	PRIORITIZATION	DEFINITION	BUILD	RELEASE	GTM
Customer evidence	1	2	0	0	0	0
Roadmap and prioritization	2	2	0	0	0	0
Ownership and decisions	0	2	2	0	0	0
Product definition and design	0	0	2	2	0	0
Product + Engineering	0	0	0	3	0	0
Release validation	0	0	0	0	1	0
Commercial enablement	0	0	0	0	2	2
Measurement and feedback	0	0	0	0	0	2
AI-enabled delivery	1	0	2	4	2	0

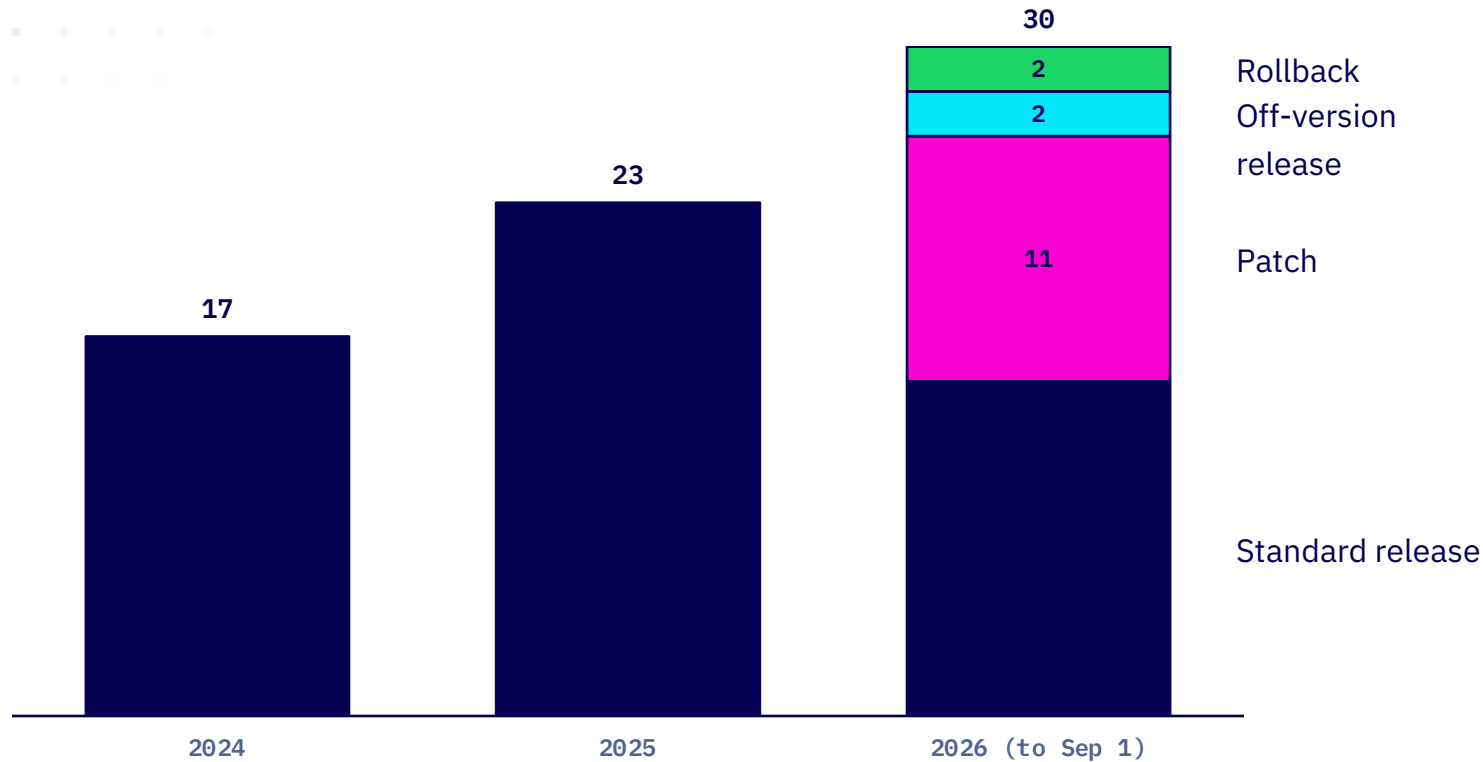
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03	Test automation	Emerging	Leading pocket	Core manual; XConnect ~100%	Variable · E2
04	Release promotion	Developing	Developing	Rebuild hypothesis; CAB gaps	To validate · E1
05	Access / test data	Emerging	Emerging	Months waiting; read-only gap	Emerging · E3
06	Operability / run	Developing	To validate	2026: half unplanned; credentials	To validate · E1
07	Delivery measures	Emerging	Emerging	Core ~65 pts; no DORA baseline	Emerging · E4
08	Knowledge sharing	Emerging	Emerging	Senior dependency; onboarding gaps	Emerging · Rec 04

Release health baseline, 2024–2026

**50%**

15 of 30 off cadence: 11 patches, 2 off-version, 2 rollbacks.

5 of 11

Patches: credentials/certificates; two expired Salesforce passwords blocked client workflows.

2

DEA (Jan), DCQ (Aug); also a held DCQ item after failed January checkout.

Half of 2026 changes were unplanned: defects, rollbacks, and credential or certificate fixes. Each merits a root-cause review (E1).
Source: DXC Production Release Calendar, Jan 2024 – Sep 2026; Core applications only; 2024–25 did not label patches.

Capture each bounded activation

01 Baseline	02 Process change	03 Visible change	04 Early signal	05 Playbook
CAPTURE ▪ Initiative + participants ▪ Cadence + artifact set RECORD Starting point	CAPTURE ▪ Name the working change ▪ Where work flows differently RECORD New method	CAPTURE ▪ What changed; who changed it ▪ Artifact or decision evidence RECORD Practice / role / measure	CAPTURE ▪ Evidence and open questions ▪ Risks and changes in the work RECORD Observed result	CAPTURE ▪ Cadence, owner and evidence ▪ Guardrail and decision RECORD How to continue

FIRST WORKING TEST • CARRY ONE INTERNAL SIGNAL THROUGH THE DEFINITION PATH

Use one live initiative

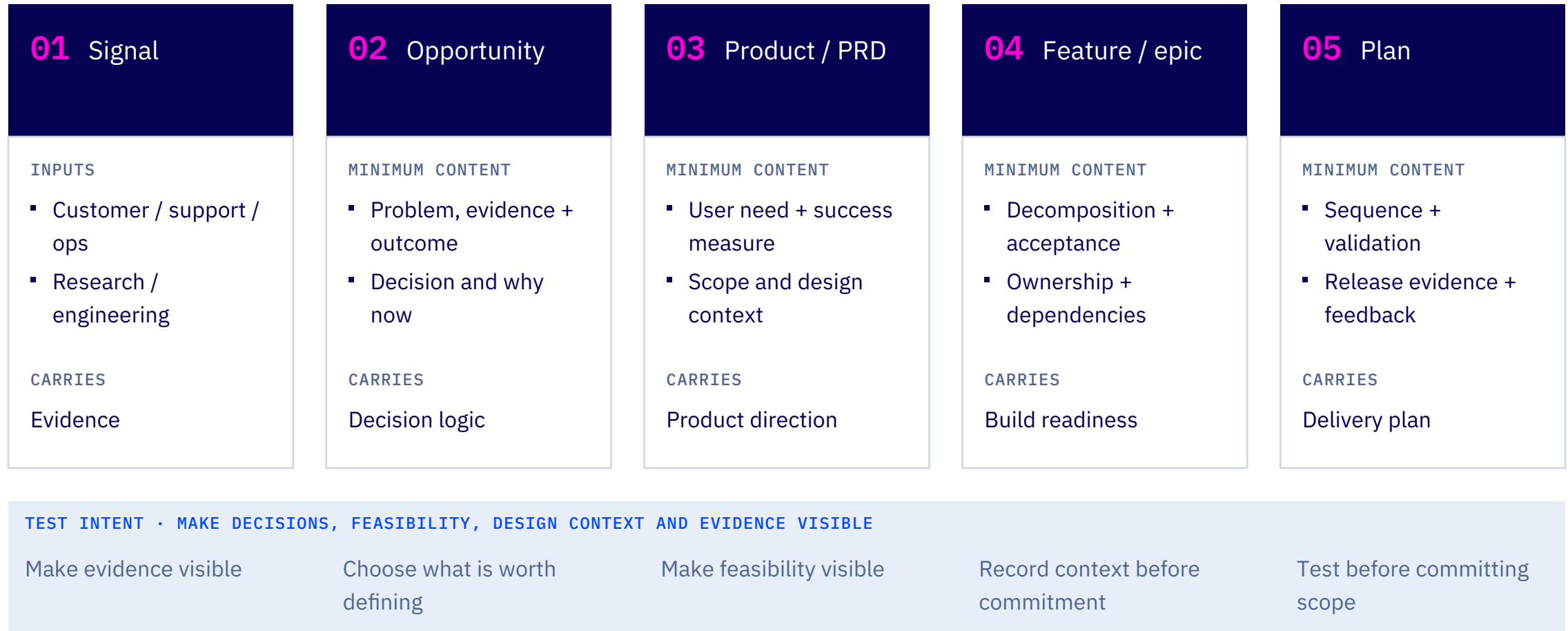
Signal through plan

Make the change observable

Do not imply proved impact

Keep a repeatable method

From signal to implementation plan



Ten recommendations across two linked tracks

TRACK	RECOMMENDATION	WHAT CHANGES	LINKED ROADMAP	START/POD
Product	01 Prioritize outcomes	Criteria; capacity; credible 3–4 sprint view	Product map	Now
Product	02 PM business ownership	PM owns evidence, outcomes and learning	Product map	Now
Product	03 Definition path	Signal → PRD → epic → design → plan	Product map	Now
Product	04 Earlier collaboration	UX / Eng / QA / Release / Ops feasibility	Product map	Next
Product	05 Ship with proof	Release proof informs roadmap learning	Product map	Next
Eng	E1 Release stability	Root causes and credential expiry	Eng map	C
Eng	E2 Test automation	Risk-led automation; reuse Recon patterns	Eng map	C
Eng	E3 Access / test data	Remove waits; masked test data	Eng map	R/RE
Eng	E4 Delivery measures	Flow / quality measures, including vendors	Eng map	C/R
Eng	E5 Governed AI	Supervised AI + PHI tools before December	Eng map	R
Rule	Two linked tracks	Product and Engineering roll into roadmaps	Both maps	Review
Key	Pilot abbreviations	C Core; R Recon; RE Rules Engine	Pilot scope	Check

Release stability and repeat causes

Engineering + Release/DevOps + Quality · unplanned changes, rollbacks, causes.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Root-cause reviews

Review patches, rollbacks and off-version changes.

02 Expiry ownership

Inventory credentials; name owners and alerts.

03 Same-artifact control

Clarify CAB coverage and configuration switches.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Now: Core

Review 15 unplanned 2026 changes; inventory expiry.

05 Next: standardize

Review causes, automate alerts and promotion checks.

06 Future: all pods

Four quality measures and repeat-cause learning.

Automate the highest-risk regression

Quality + Engineering · high-risk coverage and escaped defects.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Risk-led automation

Highest-impact workflows precede volume targets.

02 Reuse Recon patterns

Use them where the stack and workflows fit.

03 Release evidence

Require regression evidence before release.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Now: Core

Map manual effort using release root causes.

05 Next: extend

Core first, then Eligibility AI and Pay Connect.

06 Future: entry gate

Regression is a release criterion on every pod.

Unlock test data and diagnostics

DevOps/Infrastructure + Security · wait time and resolution.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Make waits visible

Who waits, for what, and for how long.

02 Production-like data

Masked data, HIPAA/PHI controls and refresh.

03 Approved diagnostics

Read-only access, including offshore teams.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Now: Recon / Rules

Log blockers and access/data waits.

05 Next: Recon

Masked data and approved read-only diagnostics.

06 Future: self-service

Environment and access provisioning across pods.

Measure delivery end to end

Engineering leadership · flow, quality and vendor delivery outcomes.

WHAT SHOULD BE DONE

01 Common baseline

Frequency, lead time, failure and restore time.

02 Connect evidence

Use release calendar and Jira data together.

03 Vendor outcomes

Measure delivered results rather than headcount.

HOW TO ACTIVATE IT

04 Now: Core + Recon

Baseline the four delivery measures.

05 Next: Recon

Activate flow metrics and a monthly vendor view.

06 Future: priorities

Use evidence in portfolio and capacity decisions.

Activation Roadmap: product track

RECOMMENDATION	OWNER	FIRST ACTION	TIMING / DEPENDENCY	MEASURE
Prioritize outcomes	Product + Eng	Apply criteria to the next live priority decision.	Now · Decision criteria	Predictability
PM business ownership	Product	Name PM outcome owner; map decision rights.	Now · Role clarity	Outcome learning
Definition path	Product + Eng	Signal → PRD → epic → design → plan	Now · Shared artifacts	Handoff quality
Earlier collaboration	Product + Eng	Review feasibility before commitment	Next · Cadence and access	Rework and wait time
Ship with proof	Product + Release	Define release proof and learning	Next · Measures	Validation coverage
Review after test	Named owners	Update the next activation	After each quick win	Phase 2 enablement

Artifact ownership matrix

L · Lead C · Contribute I · Inform A · Approve

ROLE / STAKEHOLDER	OPPORTUNITY	PRODUCT	FEATURE	TECHNICAL PLAN	QA / UAT	RELEASE / GTM
Product Manager / Product Lead	L	L	C	I	C	L
Business / Initiative Sponsor	A	A	I	I	I	A
Product Owner / Delivery Lead	C	C	L	C	C	C
UX / Design	C	C	C	I	I	C
Engineering Lead / Architect	C	C	C	L	C	C
QA / UAT	I	I	C	C	L	C
Release / Operations	I	I	C	C	C	A
Sales / Customer Success	I	C	I	I	I	C
Leadership	I	I	I	I	I	I

A marks the stage-gate approver(s). Multiple approvals are intentional where Product, Engineering, QA, or Release share a readiness decision. The lead owns the handoff to the next artifact.

Keep the live test focused and learn quickly

Up to 2

live initiatives

3 weeks

launch to executive readout

Up to 3

bounded quick wins

None

production-system change

Leadership wants meaningful opportunities identified quickly, then activated through live work.

Source: Original working scope: validate, improve and activate ways of working; the limits are scope boundaries, not measured outcomes.

WHY THIS WORK MATTERS

DentalXChange is growing and maturing its SaaS business. The value is a faster, more consistent delivery system that keeps pace with growth.

Activation Roadmap: engineering priorities

PRACTICE / FIRST PILOT	NOW	NEXT	FUTURE
Release • Core/Recon	- Unplanned changes + owners - Release Agent outputs	- Same artifact + expiry alerts - Recon Release Agent live	- Low-risk on-demand release - Agent pattern on all pods
Test • Core/Recon/Rules	- High-risk Core regression - Log access / data waits	- Automate; Eligibility + Pay - Masked production-like data	- Regression is entry criterion - Self-service environments
Quality • Rules/Core/Recon	- PRD → signed agent tech spec - Four delivery baselines	- Core technical template - Recon flow + monthly quality	Quality informs priorities
AI guardrail • All pods	- PHI rule + sanctioned tools - Staff / contractor access	- Govern December AIDLC - Shared agent registry	Scale speed + quality gains
Rollout sequence	- Pilot Core + Reconcile AI - Pilot Rules Engine	- Extend to Eligibility AI - Extend to Pay Connect	Other pods; light, gated Core AI

PRODUCT STRATEGY

Product strategy spike

1 • OUTCOME

Clear product direction and an executable six-month roadmap

2 • KEY ACTIVITIES • FOUR-WEEK SPIKE

01 • EVIDENCE

Evidence

- Review customer needs
- Review product performance
- Review business priorities

02 • STRATEGY

Strategy

- Prepare a strategy workshop
- Facilitate with product leaders
- Align on product strategy

03 • PRIORITIES

Priorities

- Set product-area direction
- Define measurable outcomes
- Agree roadmap trade-offs

04 • ROADMAP

Roadmap

- Complete product briefs
- Define ownership
- Plan six-month handoffs

3 • ALL 3 WORKSTREAMS

345K USD · total

DELIVERABLES

Product direction, measures and an executable six-month roadmap

PRODUCT TEAM

Sameer Karim · Executive PT
Mzati Kapalamula · Senior FT

PRICING SCOPE

\$370K – \$25K credit = \$345K.
All 3: Product 4w; Eng 6w; QA 6w.

Source: DentalXChange proposed next phase · Phase 1 credit; package fees cover all three workstreams.

DENTALXCHANGE • DRAFT FOR INTERNAL REVIEW • OCTOBER 2026

Engineering findings and action plan

Core SDLC • Agile with Claude Code • Robust QA • Metrics



DXC
Engineering

Six engineering findings, each with a clear fix

WHAT WE SAW

Evidence to verify; fixes to decide

Core release calendar, working sessions and survey (n=44). Confirm cause classification with release management before presenting.

01 Unplanned

15/30 Core events unplanned; causes not trended. Two-week triage fix list.

02 Repeats

Salesforce expiry blocked HS1 twice. Inventory owners and alerts.

03 Promotion

Four-day window; non-prod pre-live. Harden and promote tested build.

04 AI access

Most QA contractors lack Claude. Extend sanctioned access and guardrails.

05 Spec first

Rules MVP date precedes platform/team decisions. Sign spec before date.

06 QA capacity

21 → 200+ tests; one lead, ~15 testers. Host tools, cover paths, name QA lead.

Source: Draft evidence; details and verification qualifications retained in notes.

Four engineering moves answer the findings

FINDINGS 1/2/3

Stabilize Core SDLC

- 9–10-day hardening; same tested build promoted
- Hotfix lane, root-cause review and expiry alerts
- Both workstreams

FINDINGS 4/5

Agile with Claude

- Ready tests and technical notes; spec before date
- Pair on code, unit tests and docs; PR bot + second reviewer
- Reconcile AI engineering across Core

FINDINGS 3/4/6

Robust QA

- Automate defined critical paths, ~10–15% today
- Host QA agents, PR bot and Jira test generator in DXC
- QA lead + sanctioned Claude for every tester; Testing & release

METRICS GAP / 1

Measure what matters

- Four delivery measures: frequency, lead time, failure, restore
- Stage flow, unplanned work and commitment reliability
- QA / AI cost measures; both workstreams

Source: All four: sanctioned Claude, contractors included; DXC accounts, no PHI, human review before merge. No Core re-platforming.

Stabilize the Core flow with seven gates

EXISTING CORE FLOW

Gates on the flow Core already runs

CONTEXT

Keep Java and Scrum. Same-build promotion is the pipeline touch; settle branching and template environments for two releases in flight.

CLAUDE ASSISTS; PEOPLE APPROVE

- Draft acceptance criteria and tests
- Size slices; pair on code, unit tests and docs
- Pre-review PRs; draft reviewed backlog tests
- Draft release notes and root-cause summaries

DXC OWNERSHIP

- Refine: PMs + QA; Plan: scrum master
- Build: Core engineers; Review: Core lead
- QA: QA lead; Release: Release + DevOps
- Patch: Release; keep senior review for high risk

#	CORE STAGE	ADDED GATE
01	Refine	Ready: tests and technical notes before sprint
02	Plan	Reserve a run lane for support and patches
03	Build	Code, unit tests and docs before PR
04	Review	PR bot in pipeline + rotating second reviewer
05	QA	Critical paths automated; release evidence
06	Release	9–10-day hardening; promote tested build
07	Patch	RCA within sprint; credential/cert alerts

Ten engineering measures; targets are hypotheses

GROUP	MEASURE	TODAY → PROPOSED TARGET	BASIS / DECISION	WHEN
Delivery	Unplanned; 90d post-phase	50% (15/30) → ≤25%	Halve triaged share	90d
Delivery	Repeat causes	Salesforce expiry twice → 0	Inventory + alerts	W3+
Control	Owned / alerted	No inventory found → 100%	Credentials / certs	W3
Release	Test window	3–4 days → 9–10 days	QA existing plan	W3+
Release	Matching builds	Unknown / merge on release day → 100%	Promotion rule	W6
Quality	Critical-path tests	~10–15% → ~30% (hypothesis)	QA + 2 QE engineers	W6
Flow	Ready stories	Not tracked → ≥80%	Pilot / Ready check	W6
Access	Sanctioned AI	Some FT; no contractors → 100%	W2 access decision	W3
Commit	Signed spec	Not consistent → 100% new commitments	Spec-before-date	W2+
Measure	4 delivery metrics	Not measured → baseline, then targets	Need baseline first	W2/6
Confirm	Target hypotheses	Confirm all proposed targets at week 2	Owner agreement	W2
Review	Scorecard / scale	Review evidence; decide what scales	Next-pod decision	W6

Build on DXC's assets in the next phase

DXC EFFORT • ESTIMATES

Confirm time with each owner

- **Leadership.** 1h/week + three 1h gates; Core lead 4h/week + workshop.
- **QA / Release.** QA lead 4h/week; Release 3h/week.
- **DevOps / Security.** DevOps 1 day/week (W2–6); Security one review (W1–3).
- **Product / Pilot.** PMs 2h/week; pilot engineers a three-day workshop.

01 Core SDLC

DXC: CAB, calendar, build IDs, QA hardening. WM adds patch RCA, cert inventory, same-build design and VM templating with DevOps.

02 Agile with Claude

DXC: Scrum, Copilot, some Claude and Reconcile pipeline. WM adds Core skills, Ready / PR gates, workshop and coaching.

03 Robust QA

DXC: Playwright, agents, PR bot and defined paths. WM adds two full-time QE engineers for one sprint, coverage, AWS hosting and evidence.

04 Metrics

DXC: Jira, calendar, build IDs and QA AI-cost log. WM adds definitions, cause codes and dashboard aligned with Product metrics.

ENGINEERING APPENDIX

Appendix: detailed plans

Core SDLC · Agile with Claude Code · Robust QA · Metrics

The logo for DXC Engineering, featuring the letters "DXC" in a large, bold, white sans-serif font, with the word "Engineering" in a smaller, white sans-serif font directly below it. The text is centered within a dark blue square, which is itself positioned on the right side of the slide. The square is partially overlaid by a light gray dotted grid pattern that extends across the upper right portion of the slide.

Core SDLC today: seven weak points

CURRENT CORE FLOW

A working flow with weak points

CONTEXT

Core already runs Java and Scrum. Today the delivery number is story points; lead time, failure rate and waiting time are not measured.

WHAT IS ALREADY WORKING

- Two-week sprints; ~65 points; lead assigns by skill
- Copilot in IntelliJ; Claude for some staff
- QA automation grew 21 → 200+ in five months
- Senior Core PR review and production smoke checks

WHERE CONTROL IS THIN

- QA and design absent from refinement
- Support and patches draw on the same people
- Pre-live is not prod-like; branches merge on release day
- Most QA is manual; defined path coverage ~10–15%

#	CURRENT STAGE	OBSERVED WEAKNESS
01	Refine	PMs + engineers vote; QA/design absent
02	Plan	Two-week sprint; support uses same capacity
03	Build	Docs after coding; offshore lacks live data
04	Review	Senior bottleneck; QA PR bot on demand
05	QA	200+ automated; mostly manual; no load test
06	Release	4-day window; UAT / QA 3–4 days
07	Patch	15 unplanned events; causes not trended

Stabilize Core SDLC: action plan

ACTION	WHAT / DONE WHEN	DXC OWNER	WM ROLE	WEEKS
Patch triage	Classify 15 unplanned events; every event has cause + owner	Release	QE Architect	W1–2
Cert inventory	Inventory expiry, owner and alert; 100% owned / alerted	Release + DevOps	QE Architect	W1–3
Hardening	Adopt 9–10 days; settle branching; first release in new window	Leadership + QA + Release	Exec Eng Leader	W1–3
VM templates	Support two releases in flight; no environment conflict	DevOps + app architects	QE Architect	W2–6
Same build	Promote tested pre-live build; IDs match for every release	DevOps + Release	QE Architect	W3–6
Hotfix lane	Review patch / rollback cause within sprint; RCA before close	Release + Core lead	QE Architect	W2–6

Source: W2: decide triage owner, hardening, promotion rule and environment funding. Measures: unplanned share, repeats, window, matching builds.

Agile with Claude Code: five ceremony changes

CEREMONY	TODAY	CLAUDE ASSISTANCE	HUMAN GATE
Refinement	Points voted; QA absent	Draft criteria, tests and notes	PM + QA approve Ready
Planning	~65 points; skills assign	Smaller slices; separate run lane	Scrum master / lead own capacity
Build	Core Java; Copilot; docs after code	Pair on code, unit tests and docs	Engineer owns each merged line
Review	Senior Core reviewer	QA PR bot on every Core PR	Rotating second; senior for high risk
Retro	Each sprint; no flow data	Cycle time, escaped / unplanned	One change per sprint; track AI cost

Agile with Claude Code: action plan

ACTION	WHAT / DONE WHEN	DXC OWNER	WM ROLE	WEEKS
Spec before date	Engineering estimate + signed Rules Engine spec before date	Product + Eng leadership	Exec Eng Leader	W1–2
Ready gate	Criteria, tests, notes; signed agent-drafted pilot spec before sprint	Core lead + PM + QA	Senior Architect	W1–4
Core skills	Versioned Java spec / unit / review / docs skills; test on real epic	Core lead	Senior Architect	W1–3
Pairing pilot	Real stories, two sprints; W4 hands-on workshop	Core engineers	Senior Architect	W3–6
PR gate	Pipeline PR bot; rotating second reviewer; each Core PR	Core lead + QA	Senior Architect	W2–5
Sprint learning	Reserve run lane; two retros use delivery data	Scrum master + PM	Senior Architect	W1–6

Source: W2: approve spec-before-date and sanctioned Claude for contractor pilot. Measures: signed specs, stage cycle time, Ready and AI pre-review.

Robust QA: scale existing tools in seven layers

BUILD ON FIVE MONTHS OF QA WORK

Layer by layer; reviewed by people

CONTEXT

Keep the Playwright framework and Claude tools QA already built. Productionize the agents, PR bot and Jira story-to-test generator.

CURRENT CAPACITY AND LIMITS

- One leader for ~15 testers; two full-time staff
- Core: 200+ automated tests, but mostly manual
- Defined critical paths ~10–15%; no performance tests
- UAT / QA has only 3–4 days today

WHAT THE NEXT PHASE ADDS

- Name or hire a QA lead for Core
- Sanctioned Claude practice for contractors too
- Two full-time QE engineers for one sprint
- DXC hosting, pipeline integration and release evidence

#	QA LAYER	OWNER / CHANGE
01	Refinement	QA lead + PM: criteria / tests before build
02	Unit	Core + Claude: reviewed tests on changed code
03	API / UI	QA: daily agents and PR-reviewed test backlog
04	Critical paths	QA + Product: automate defined paths by release
05	Performance	QA + DevOps: highest-volume baseline
06	UAT	Product: realistic pre-live, hardening window
07	Prod checks	Release + DevOps: smoke checks + evidence

Robust QA: action plan

ACTION	WHAT / DONE WHEN	DXC OWNER	WM ROLE	WEEKS
Critical paths	Defined Core paths ~10–15% → ~30% by W6 (hypothesis)	QA lead	QE Senior Eng	W1–6
Agent tests	Run reviewed backlog tests daily; merge each sprint after PR review	QA lead	QE Senior Eng	W1–4
PR bot	Bitbucket pipeline; every QA PR; monthly cost reporting	QA + DevOps	QE Architect	W2–4
Jira test gen	Host in DXC AWS; human approval; one pilot team	QA + DevOps + Security	QE Architect	W3–6
Access / practice	Sanctioned Claude for all testers, contractors included; review before PR	QA + Eng leadership	Exec Eng Leader	W1–2
QA lead	Name or hire Core QA lead; agree one FT QA per pod over time	Eng leadership	Exec Eng Leader	W1–2

Source: W2: QA lead, contractor access and DXC home for AI tools. Measures: critical paths (~30% hypothesis), reviewed tests, escaped causes, AI cost.

Ten metrics from data DXC already has

GROUP	METRIC	DEFINITION	EXISTING SOURCE	CADENCE
Delivery	Deploy frequency	Production releases per month	Calendar / builds	Month
Delivery	Lead time	Merge → production, days	Git / builds	Month
Delivery	Change failure	Share needing patch or rollback	Calendar / tickets	Month
Delivery	Restore time	Incident opened → service restored	Support tickets	Month
Flow	Cycle by stage	Days in each Jira status	Jira	Sprint
Flow	Unplanned share	Capacity spent on support / patches	Jira labels	Sprint
Flow	Commit reliability	Stories done vs committed	Jira	Sprint
Quality	Escaped defects	Production defects per release, by cause	Tickets / Jira	Release
Quality	Critical-path tests	Share of defined paths automated	Test suite	Release
AI	Adoption / cost	Sanctioned builders; model cost per run	Access / QA cost	Month
Start	Baseline / define	W1–2 baseline; W3–4 definitions + cause codes	Existing data	W1–4
Review	Dashboard	W5–6 dashboard; retro + leadership review	Core / new / vendor	W5–6

Trace findings to workstreams and week-6 results

#	FINDING	MOVE	WORKSTREAM	WEEK-6 RESULT	MEASURE
1	Unplanned / untracked	Stabilize Core	Test / release	Classify every unplanned change; hotfix RCA	Events / repeats
2	Same failure twice	Stabilize Core	Test / release	Credential / cert owners + alerts	0 repeat incidents
3	Tested ≠ shipped	Stabilize Core	Test / release	Hardening, VM templates, same build	Window / build IDs
4	AI locked to few	Claude + QA	Both	Sanctioned access for all; pipeline PR bot	Builders with access
5	Dates before design	Agile / Claude	Reconcile AI	Signed agent-drafted Rules spec; spec before date	Signed commitments
6	QA capacity gap	Robust QA	Test / release	QA lead, DXC-hosted tools; path coverage rises	Paths automated
7	No delivery numbers	Metrics	Both	Baseline metrics and monthly dashboard	Metrics live
→	Each workstream	Findings → fixes	Both	Specific findings; measurable W6 results	Review at W6

Six weeks, two workstreams and three decision gates

ACTION GROUP	WEEKS 1-2	WEEKS 3-4	WEEKS 5-6
Core: SDLC	- Map + Ready / spec-before-date (W1-2) - Core skills (W1-3)	- Finish skills (W3) - Pilot completes (W4)	— —
Core: AI / metrics	- Rules Engine pilot starts (W1-4) - Baseline / dashboard (W1-6)	- Claude pairing + PR gate (W3-6) - Hands-on workshop at W4	- Continue pairing / PR gate - Metrics dashboard review at W6
Test / release: stability	- Patch W1-2; certs W1-3 - Harden W1-3; templates W2-6	- Continue templated environments - Same-build promotion (W3-6)	Environments / same build continue
Test / release: QA tools	- Critical paths / agent tests (W1-6) - PR bot pipeline (W2-4)	- Jira test generator in DXC (W3-6) - Critical paths / agent tests continue	Tests / Jira generator continue
Decisions / guardrail	- W2: QA lead + AI access; owners - W2: harden; Ready / PR; spec rule	- W4: workshop on real Core epics —	W6: scorecard / next-pod decision

Eight dependencies: five need week-2 decisions

RISK / DEPENDENCY	OWNER / DUE	MITIGATION	IF IT SLIPS
Claude access + PHI rule	Eng / Sec W2	Decide W2; start with full-time pilot users	AI moves stall for contractors
Security / QA tools in AWS	Sec / Ops W3	Start review W1 on existing Claude subscription	Test generator / PR bot stay manual
Environment templating capacity	DevOps / Arch W2	Template pre-live first; stagger releases	Hardening cannot support two releases
QA / Core leadership load	Eng leaders W2	WM QE executes; name a QA lead	Actions slip; leads burn out
Branch strategy unsettled	Core / QA / Rel W2	Options paper; decide at W2 gate	Hardening window blocked
CAB switched-off code rule	Release / CAB W3	Written rule in release gate	Release friction continues
Baseline data quality	Eng leaders W3	Calendar + build IDs; add Jira cause codes	Metrics are not trusted
Rules Engine platform undecided	Prod / Eng W2	Keep spec platform-neutral; decide W2	Spec-first pilot delayed

Proposed main-deck edits • internal review only

PROPOSED SUMMARY LINES	Saw: unplanned / repeat failure / tested ≠ shipped Saw: AI access / dates before design / QA staffing	Do: Core SDLC / Claude / robust QA / metrics Decide at W2; review scorecard at W6
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PROPOSED CHANGES FOR DISCUSSION

SLIDE	MAIN-DECK TOPIC	PROPOSED CHANGE	QUALIFICATION
6	Executive summary	Six finding hooks, four moves, W2 decisions	Proposed replacement
12	Engineering practices	Fix “one QA” + patch claim, or appendix	Internal recommendation
19+	19/20/31: prior content	Move to graveyard; four moves / plans replace	Proposed, not applied
21+	21–23: priorities	Replace with Core, Claude, QA and metrics	Proposed, not applied
25+	25/32: roadmap	Now / Next / Future; no agentic Future delivery	Internal recommendation
39+	39/40: workstreams	Moves / gates; QA framework, VM templates, hardening	Build on existing tools
3+	3/7/40: editorial	3 duplicates 35; 7 empty; 40 “Datatabase” typo	Source observations